

What new cyber threats will emerge soon?



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BARRACUDA NETWORKS

AI will be a catalyst for cyber threat evolution. Attackers will progress from using generative AI to refine and scale phishing emails to leveraging AI technologies in many other ways. For example, to create or adapt malicious code using tools such as WormGPT and EvilGPT, which will automate the discovery and exploitation of weaknesses or enable the creation of adaptive malware that can evade detection.



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QUICK HEAL

As the value of cryptocurrency fluctuates, we can expect attackers to develop more cunning methods to exploit vulnerabilities and maximise their illicit gains. As AI and other emerging technologies continue to grow, deep fakes and hyper-personalised scams are likely to become more sophisticated. Attackers will leverage advancements in AI to create highly believable digital forgeries and craft social engineering campaigns.



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CHECK POINT

Nation state attacks and hacktivism will increase with geo-political instability fueling activities like DDoS attacks, often masking commercial motives with political agendas. Ransomware threats will exploit legitimate system tools, despite take-downs of malware networks like Qbot, necessitating advanced security measures like Managed Detection and Response (MDR).



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KASPERSKY

In the future, we'll see an increased use of neural networks to generate visuals for scams. According to our security experts, there is a noticeable upward trend in attacks targeting mobile devices. In 2023 alone, the number of such attacks surged to 33,790,599, representing a significant increase of almost 52%, compared to the 22,255,956 attacks recorded in 2022. The most prevalent threat to mobile devices was adware, a type of software that displays unwanted pop-up adverts.



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The next few years could see an escalation in the speed, scale, and sophistication of cyberattacks, threatening global security. Nation-state cyber activity is expected to rise, targeting critical infrastructure with sophisticated techniques. Additionally, the weaponization of AI by adversaries is a growing concern, with AI playing a significant role in future threats. These trends indicate a future where cybersecurity threats are more advanced, stealthy, and potentially damaging.